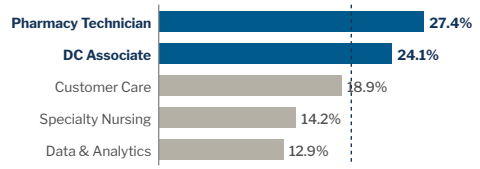
Chart cheat sheet

McKesson data-viz guide · for decks, reports and workbooks

1. Every chart has the same anatomy

1 **Two frontline job families lose about 1 in 4 people a year, well above the 19.9% enterprise rate**

2 Voluntary attrition by job family, FY26 (%)



3

4 Voluntary attrition = voluntary exits ÷ average headcount.
Source: Workday HCM, as of 31 Mar 2026; U.S. regular employees

1. **Headline** = the insight. A full sentence with the number, ≤ 2 lines, no final period.
2. **Subtitle** = the measure: metric, unit, scope, period. Neutral.
3. **Chart**: grey context, blue focus, direct labels, a labelled benchmark.
4. **Footnote + source**: definition, system, as-of date, population.

2. Write the headline last, from the numbers

Who or what + verb + number + so what. If you can't write it, you don't have a finding yet.

LABEL Attrition by job family

VAGUE Attrition varies across job families

INSIGHT Two frontline job families lose about 1 in 4 people a year

Recompute every "all", "most", "2x" and "n of m" from the data.

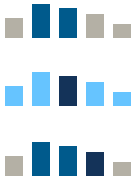
PICK THE CHART FROM THE QUESTION

How big → **sorted bar** · Over time → **line** · Parts of a whole → **100% bar** or **waterfall** · Spread → **histogram / strip** · Two measures → **scatter** · Flows → **Sankey** · One number → **KPI**. Full guide: chart-chooser.pdf

3. Grey first, then color the headline's point

Context · everything else	`#B4B0A5`
Focus · what the headline names	`#005A8C`
Accent · the one exception (navy)	`#143359`
Total / benchmark · totals, targets (dashed)	`#143359`
Context light · de-emphasized fills	`#DEDBD1`

THREE HIGHLIGHT PATTERNS



Focus (default): all grey, headline items blue

Uniform + accent: one series light blue, the exception navy

Focus + accent: grey, blue group, one navy exception

At most 2 highlighted items. Bold the matching category label.

CATEGORIES (MAX 6, IN THIS ORDER)



`005A8C` `143359` `66C4FF` `00AF9D` `00737A` `EF8200`

ONE MEASURE, LIGHT TO DARK



`E6F3FB` `B6E2FA` `66C4FF` `009EFF` `0A5FBC` `143359`

GAP TO A BENCHMARK (CENTERED ON 0)



`A75B00` `EF8200` `F7C180` `EFEDE7` `99BDD1` `005A8C` `143359`

NEVER

- Orange as a plain highlight (it means "worse"), red vs. green, rainbow bars, or color as the only cue
- 3D, shadows, gradients, borders, or a legend labels could replace
- Truncated bars or dual axes

4. Check before you send

- [ ] Headline is an insight; every number in it is true
- [ ] Subtitle has metric, unit, scope and period
- [ ] Grey context; ≤ 2 highlights, matching the headline
- [ ] Values labelled; value axis, gridlines and legend deleted
- [ ] Bars start at zero; Excel gap width 50%
- [ ] Sorted by value or in a natural order
- [ ] Units in the subtitle; true minus (−), explicit + on changes
- [ ] Metric defined; source has system, date, population
- [ ] No group under **10 people**, even in hover text
- [ ] Nothing overlaps; nothing below 9 pt; one left edge

TYPE ON A 16:9 SLIDE (LIBRE FRANKLIN)

Element	Style	Size
Headline	Bold, navy	24 pt
Subtitle	Regular, grey	14 pt
Data labels	Medium	12 pt
Axis, categories	Regular, light grey	11 pt
Footnote, source	Light, light grey	9 pt

ON A SLIDE

- The slide title **is** the headline; ≤ 2 charts per slide
- Build up complex charts in 2–5 steps: grey, then highlight, then callout
- Use native, editable charts, not pictures of charts

GET SET UP ONCE

Install Libre Franklin and the **McKesson Data Viz** theme (docs/office-setup.md). Start from **McKesson-DataViz.potx**, copy charts from the **starter deck** or the **chart workbook** (dist/office).